

# Ross Dahlke



Assistant Professor, School of Journalism and Mass Communication, University of Wisconsin–Madison

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## Education

### Stanford University

PhD, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2022–2024

- Dissertation: *The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications*
- Committee: Jeffrey T. Hancock (Advisor, Communication), Jennifer Pan (Communication), Byron Reeves (Communication), Matthew Gentzkow (Economics), Michael Bernstein (Chair, Computer Science)
- Stanford Data Science Scholar 2023–2024
- Knight-Hennessy Scholar 2022–2023

### Stanford University

MA, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2020–2022

- Knight-Hennessy Scholar 2020–2022

### University of Wisconsin–Madison

JBA, Comprehensive Honors (Honors in the Liberal Arts and Honors in the Major), Journalism & Mass Communication and Political Science

Madison, WI

2014–2018

## Academic Appointments

### Assistant Professor

School of Journalism and Mass Communication · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Madison, WI

2025–Present

- Affiliate, Data Science Institute 2026–Present
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center 2025–Present

## Honors & Awards

### Top Paper Award, Information Systems Division

International Communication Association Conference

2026

### Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ~5% of submissions)

ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems

2026

### Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division

International Communication Association Conference

2024

### Top Reviewer Award, 2023

Social Science Computer Review

2024

### Theodore Herfurth Award

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top undergraduate male student in the university

2018

### College of Letters and Science Dean's Prize

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top three students in the college

2018

### James L. Baughman Senior Achievement Award

University of Wisconsin–Madison · top five students in the School of Journalism and Mass Communication

2018

## Research

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### Publications

**Bold** = Dahlke · \*equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: # graduate-student or postdoctoral · ‡ undergraduate · ^ untenured junior-faculty · + tenured-faculty. All listed articles are peer-reviewed.

16. **Dahlke, R.**, Moore, R. C.<sup>#</sup>, Adib-Azpeitia, D.<sup>‡</sup>, Ugander, J.<sup>^</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Multi-platform referrers of misinformation: A comparative analysis of misinformation visits referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. *Political Communication*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10584609.2026.2679492>
15. **Dahlke, R.**, Yang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup>, Greenfield, J.<sup>#</sup>, Chen, B.<sup>#</sup>, Brown, M. A.<sup>#</sup>, & Lewis, R.<sup>#</sup> (2026). Style and substance on The Alex Jones Show predict InfoWars sales: A multi-modal analysis of a media empire. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2642851>
14. **Dahlke\***, **R.**, Moore\*, R. C.<sup>#</sup>, Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2026). The consumption of pink slime journalism: Who, what, when, where, and why? *Digital Journalism*, 1–23. <https://doi.org/10.1080/21670811.2026.2669525>  
Award · Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division of the International Communication Association 2024 Conference  
Coverage · Northwestern Local News Initiative, The Boston Globe
13. **Dahlke, R.**, Mine, N.<sup>#</sup>, Zhao, H.<sup>#</sup>, Huang, Y.<sup>#</sup>, & Shah, D.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Electoral predictions on Polymarket: A quantitative description of trading, commenting, and reacting. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, 6. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2026.011>  
Coverage · The Washington Post
12. Kim, Y. M.<sup>+</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, Song, H.<sup>^</sup>, & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123>
11. Lee, A. Y.<sup>#</sup>, Stevic, A.<sup>#</sup>, Walker-Keleher, G.<sup>‡</sup>, Chen, C.<sup>‡</sup>, Charity, E.<sup>‡</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on motivation. *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791723>  
Award · Best Paper Honorable Mention (top ~5% of submissions), ACM CHI 2026  
Coverage · The New York Times, CNBC
10. **Dahlke\***, **R.**, Tu\*, F.<sup>#</sup>, Wang\*, Y.-C.<sup>#</sup>, Lu, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Engeda, B. W.<sup>‡</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2025). Contextualizing misinformation: A user-centric approach to linguistic and topical patterns in news consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571>  
Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).
9. **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J.<sup>+</sup> (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250>
8. **Dahlke, R.**, Kumar, D.<sup>#</sup>, Durumeric, Z.<sup>^</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2025). Quantifying the systematic bias in the accessibility and inaccessibility of web scraping content from URL-logged web-browsing digital trace data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214>

7. Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup>, Macdonald, M.<sup>^</sup>, Chen, B.<sup>#</sup>, Brown, M. A.<sup>#</sup>, Prochaska, S.<sup>#</sup>, Yang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Greenfield, J.<sup>#</sup>, Suk, J.<sup>^</sup>, Zhong, W.<sup>#</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, & Borah, P.<sup>+</sup> (2025). Candidates be posting: Multi-platform strategies and partisan preferences in the 2022 US midterm elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541>
6. **Dahlke, R.**, & Pan, J.<sup>+</sup> (2024). January 6 arrests and media coverage do not remobilize conservatives on social media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121>
5. Moore\*, R. C.<sup>#</sup>, **Dahlke\***, R., Forberg, P. L.<sup>#</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2024). The private life of QAnon: A mixed methods investigation of Americans' exposure to QAnon content on the web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057>  
Note · PACM HCI is a peer-reviewed journal (ACM CSCW track).
4. **Dahlke, R.**, & Zhang, Y.<sup>^</sup> (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: A temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051>
3. Chen, B.<sup>#</sup>, Borah, P.<sup>+</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, & Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup> (2024). Battle for inbox and bucks: Comparing email fundraising strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. presidential election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012>
2. Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup>, Greenfield, J.<sup>#</sup>, Yang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, Brown, M. A.<sup>#</sup>, Lewis, R.<sup>#</sup>, & Chen, B.<sup>#</sup> (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851>
1. Moore\*, R. C.<sup>#</sup>, **Dahlke\***, R., & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2>  
Coverage · The New York Times, World Economic Forum, Minnesota Star Tribune, The Daily Beast

## Research in Progress

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### Manuscripts Under Review

**Bold** = Dahlke · \* equal or co-first authorship. Co-author status at time of submission: <sup>#</sup> graduate-student or postdoctoral · <sup>‡</sup> undergraduate · <sup>^</sup> untenured junior-faculty · <sup>+</sup> tenured-faculty.

5. **Dahlke\***, R., Moore\*, R. C.<sup>^</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. Revise & Resubmit at *Nature Communications*. [https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg\\_v1](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1)
4. Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup>, Zhang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Pruden, M.<sup>^</sup>, Prochaska, S.<sup>#</sup>, Chen, B.<sup>^</sup>, Zhong, W.<sup>^</sup>, Brown, M.<sup>#</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J.<sup>^</sup>, Greenfield, J.<sup>#</sup>, & Borah, P.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Cross-platformization: How U.S. right-leaning media curate their posts on Twitter and Truth Social. Revise & Resubmit at *New Media and Society*.
3. Kwon, H.<sup>#</sup>, Jiang, X.<sup>#</sup>, & **Dahlke, R.** (2026). Do politicians' strategic facial expressions drive resonant moments on social media? Computational analysis of the 2024 U.S. presidential debate using multimodal large language models. Revise & Resubmit at *International Journal of Communication*.  
Award · Top Paper, Information Systems Division of the International Communication Association 2026 Conference
2. **Dahlke, R.**, Lee, A. Y.<sup>#</sup>, Stevic, A.<sup>#</sup>, Walker-Keleher, G.<sup>‡</sup>, Chen, C. Q.-A.<sup>‡</sup>, Charity, E.<sup>‡</sup>, & Hancock, J. T.<sup>+</sup> (2026). Replacing smartphones with minimal mobile phones improves college students' trust in news but not news-finds-me perceptions. Under Review.

1. **Dahlke, R., & Hancock, J.<sup>+</sup>** (2025). The public sphere in private spaces: Quantifying political computer-mediated communication in personal messaging. Under Review. <https://osf.io/6cpv8/>

### *Working Papers & Reports*

1. Lukito, J.<sup>^</sup>, Brown, M. A.<sup>#</sup>, **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J.<sup>^</sup>, Yang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Zhang, Y.<sup>^</sup>, Chen, B.<sup>#</sup>, Kim, S. J.<sup>^</sup>, & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. <http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177>

## **Research Funding & Fellowships**

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|                                                                                                                                       |                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Collaborative Summer Research Initiative</b>                                                                                       | 2025              |
| University of Wisconsin–Madison Elections Research Center                                                                             | <b>\$10,700</b>   |
| <b>Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust &amp; Safety Research Grant</b>                                                       | 2024              |
| Stanford Cyber Policy Center                                                                                                          | <b>\$15,000</b>   |
| <b>Graduate Student Researcher</b>                                                                                                    | 2020–2024         |
| Office of Army Research & DoD Multidisciplinary University Research Initiative (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group |                   |
| <b>Data Science Scholar</b>                                                                                                           | 2023              |
| Stanford University Data Science                                                                                                      | <b>~\$93,000</b>  |
| <b>Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant</b>                                                                  | 2023              |
| Stanford University                                                                                                                   | <b>\$5,000</b>    |
| <b>Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant</b>                                                                  | 2023              |
| Stanford University                                                                                                                   | <b>\$3,000</b>    |
| <b>Knight–Hennessy Scholarship</b>                                                                                                    | 2020              |
| Stanford University                                                                                                                   | <b>~\$280,000</b> |

## **Presentations**

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### *Invited Talks & Guest Lectures*

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Political Content and Sources in Personal Messaging</b> | March 2026     |
| Communication and Media Colloquium · University of Iowa                                         |                |
| <b>Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research</b>         | October 2025   |
| Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025 · University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign     |                |
| <b>The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why?</b>               | March 2025     |
| J395: Language, Media, and Politics · University of Texas at Austin (Virtual)                   |                |
| <b>Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science</b>                                    | November 2024  |
| Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University                            |                |
| <b>Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election</b>                | November 2023  |
| Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology · Stanford University                          |                |
| <b>Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects</b>                                               | November 2023  |
| Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University                            |                |
| <b>Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization</b>                                       | September 2023 |
| University of Minnesota–Twin Cities                                                             |                |
| <b>Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election</b>                | April 2023     |
| Social Technologies Research Group · Cornell Tech                                               |                |

## Teaching

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### *Courses*

**JOURN / LIS (Information Science) 677** – Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization      *Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026*

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

**JOURN 818** – Computational Approaches for Communication Research

*Fall 2025*

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

**COMM 124/224** – Truth, Trust & Technology

*Spring 2024*

Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

**COMM 172/272** – Media Psychology

*Winter 2023*

Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

**INTER-LS 250** – Undergraduate Research Experience

*Fall 2016, Spring 2017, Fall 2017, Spring 2018*

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Teaching Fellow

### *Professional Development*

**Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence Fellow**

*August 2025–May 2026*

Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring · University of Wisconsin–Madison

**The Discussion Project**

*August 2025*

Wisconsin Center for Education Research · University of Wisconsin–Madison

**Wisconsin Idea Seminar**

*May 2025*

Office of the Provost · University of Wisconsin–Madison

## Advising

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### *PhD Advising*

**Yanshu (Sybil) Wang**

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

**Laila Abbas**

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Co-Advisor (with Dhavan Shah)

**Haotian (Barry) Zhao**

PhD, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

### *Research MA Advising*

**Yingqi (Vicky) Huang**

MA, Journalism and Mass Communication · Advisor

### *Directed Study*

**Yanshu (Sybil) Wang**

*Spring 2026*

Directed Study

**Yanshu (Sybil) Wang**

*Fall 2025*

Directed Study

## Service

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### *Departmental & University Service*

**Graduate Committee, School of Journalism and Mass Communication**

Member

*January 2025–Present*

**SJMC COWathon (CODing and Writing-athon)**

Organizer

*October 2025*

### *Professional Service*

**Computation + Journalism 2026 Symposium, Northwestern University**

Program Committee Member · <https://www.cj2026.northwestern.edu/>

*May 2026–Present*

**International Journal of Press + Politics**

Data Editor

*January 2025–Present*

**Media & Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC)**

Research Chair, Executive Board Member · <https://mddatacoop.org/>

*September 2020–Present*

**International Communication Association Hackathon**

Co-Organizer · <https://www.hackingcommsci.org/>

*June 2023–June 2024*

**Digital Data Conference (D2C)**

Co-Organizer · <https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/>

*December 2021–April 2022*

### *Peer Review*

- AI and Ethics
- Communication Methods and Measures
- Computational Communication Research
- HKS Misinformation Review
- Human Communication Research
- Information Processing and Management
- International Journal of Communication
- International Journal of Public Opinion Research
- Journal of Online Trust and Safety
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Journal of Right-Wing Studies
- Mass Communication & Society
- New Media & Society
- Political Communication
- Science Advances
- Social Science Computer Review
- Virtual Reality

## Professional Experience

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**Data Scientist**

Ovative Group

*Minneapolis, MN*

*2018–2020*